

WEBDAV RUNDLL32 ORDINAL HUNT

Defender XDR hunt for source-observed execution of disguised DLLs directly from WebDAV UNC paths through export ordinal #1.

HUNTING QUERY

CONFIDENCE: MEDIUM

REPORT DATE	STATUS
9 September 2026	Untested implementation sketch
PRIMARY TELEMETRY	OPERATIONAL VALUE
Defender XDR / DeviceProcessEvents	9.6 / 10

Behavioral execution hunt. A match does not prove ClickFix delivery, Amatera execution, credential theft, NetSupport installation or C2.

CONTROLLED EIGHT-PAGE THREAT DOSSIER





EXECUTIVE ASSESSMENT

Decision-grade summary and strict evidence boundary.

ASSESSMENT

OPERATIONAL VALUE

9.6

Direct process telemetry captures a distinctive signed-binary proxy execution pattern without depending on mutable filenames, domains or hashes.

CLASSIFICATION

Behavioral execution hunt

Hunting query - Untested implementation sketch. Legacy administration and software deployment overlap must be measured locally.

1primary event

3direct filters

0thresholds

0joins

Source fact

Talos observed 32-bit rundll32.exe execute disguised DLLs from WebDAV UNC paths using export ordinal #1.

Analytical choice

The hunt omits mutable names pf.ch and verification.google and selects only the directly observed execution mechanics.

Assumption

Defender for Endpoint retains the UNC path and ordinal token in the full created-process command line.

Evidence boundary

A match does not establish ClickFix, WebClient startup, successful transfer, payload behavior, credential collection, BYOVD, remote access or C2.



THREAT MECHANICS

Observed delivery chain and selected detection point.

BEHAVIOR

01
Compromised site

ClearFake JavaScript was injected through a malicious Cloudflare Worker.
→

02
EtherHiding

Browser code was retrieved from BNB Smart Chain contracts.
→

03
ClickFix prompt

A fake Google CAPTCHA directed the victim to paste a command.

04
WebDAV path

The command opened a randomized remote UNC location.
→

05
Ordinal launch

32-bit rundll32.exe invoked export #1 in pf.ch or verification.google.
→

06
Follow-on

Recovered branches led to Amatera and separate secondary tasking.

Evidence point	Directly supported statement
Publication	Cisco Talos, 8 September 2026.
Observed activity	verification.google event in April 2026; related chain and payload activity through July 2026.
Selected signal	rundll32.exe, remote UNC/WebDAV path and ordinal #1.
Excluded from query	Filename, domain, hash, service correlation, C2 and downstream payload behavior.

ATT&CK

T1218.011 Signed Binary Proxy Execution: Rundll32. No transfer or credential-access technique is inferred from the process event.



TELEMETRY AND DATA CONTRACT

Minimum evidence required for a defensible hunt.

TELEMETRY

REQUIRED

DeviceProcessEvents

Microsoft Defender for Endpoint process creation with created image and full command line.

OPTIONAL ENRICHMENT

WebClient service events, DeviceNetworkEvents, DeviceFileEvents, browser history, proxy or DNS, and remote file acquisition.

Field	Reliability	Purpose
Timestamp, DeviceId, DeviceName	Documented	Scope and investigation pivots
FileName	Documented	rundll32.exe condition
ProcessCommandLine	Documented	UNC and #1 conditions
FolderPath, SHA1	Documented	Created-image verification
Account fields	Documented	User attribution
InitiatingProcess fields	Documented	Parent investigation
ReportId	Documented	Use with DeviceName and Timestamp

Unavailable in the primary event

Remote payload bytes, browser JavaScript, blockchain content, memory-only Amatera, successful C2 and secondary task completion.

Coverage failure

No Defender for Endpoint, truncated command line, local staging, renamed proxy binary, different ordinal, or activity outside retention.



HUNTING LOGIC

Three direct conditions; no threshold, join or aggregation.

KQL

HYPOTHESIS

If an attacker executes a disguised DLL directly from WebDAV through rundll32.exe and ordinal #1, endpoint telemetry should record rundll32.exe with a UNC path and #1 in its command line. Legitimate activity can be separated through server provenance, package ownership, account context and artifact acquisition.

KQL - UNTESTED HUNT

```
DeviceProcessEvents
| where FileName =~ "rundll32.exe"
| where ProcessCommandLine contains @"\\"
| where ProcessCommandLine contains "#1"
| project Timestamp, DeviceId, DeviceName, ActionType,
    FileName, FolderPath, ProcessCommandLine,
    SHA1, AccountDomain, AccountName, AccountUpn,
    InitiatingProcessFileName, InitiatingProcessFolderPath,
    InitiatingProcessCommandLine, InitiatingProcessSHA1,
    ProcessIntegrityLevel, ProcessTokenElevation, ReportId
| order by Timestamp desc
```

THRESHOLD	WINDOW	JOIN	KEY	STATUS
None	Analyst selected	None	Single event	Untested



TRIAGE AND INVESTIGATION

Convert a match into attributable evidence.

WORKFLOW

1

Validate command line

Confirm the UNC server, share, remote filename, ordinal and created image path.

2

Establish provenance

Identify server owner, account, initiating process, deployment package and change record.

3

Acquire artifacts

Collect the remote file where possible and confirm whether the disguised object is a PE DLL.

4

Trace delivery

Review WebClient startup, browser history, Run dialog evidence, proxy and DNS records.

5

Scope follow-on

Hunt for Amatera, suspicious PowerShell, sideloading, driver activity, NetSupport and C2.

Escalate

Internet-facing WebDAV, disguised PE, unknown initiator, suspicious browser context or downstream payload evidence.

Benign context

Approved internal share, verified signed package, known owner and matching change record.

Inconclusive

Historical event with inaccessible remote share, truncated command line or missing parent context.

Response boundary

Do not attribute or contain solely from this match. Verify remote-object provenance and surrounding delivery or payload evidence.



FALSE POSITIVES AND VALIDATION

Promotion gates for operational use.

QUALITY CONTROL

SCENARIO	OVERLAP	DISPOSITION
Legacy software deployment	M	Verify server, package and owner
Administrative diagnostics	M	Verify account, ticket and remote DLL
Internal application share	M	Validate signed content and change record
Internet WebDAV and disguised PE	H	Collect and scope immediately

Validation steps

1. Run a benign WebDAV DLL through rundll32 and ordinal #1.
2. Confirm literal UNC and ordinal retention.
3. Measure all hits across available retention.
4. Classify source servers, packages and owners.

Decision criteria

Success: controlled event is complete and real hits are separable by provenance.

Rejection: frequent legitimate activity is inseparable.

Failure: command line or process telemetry is unavailable.

Tuning

Allowlist only verified server-share-package-owner combinations. Never suppress rundll32.exe, WebClient, UNC paths or ordinal #1 globally.



CONCLUSION AND REFERENCES

Coverage statement, cross-platform limits and document control.

FINAL

CONCLUSION

A source-backed remote DLL execution hunt.

The three filters are directly observed and Defender fields are documented. Local prevalence and administrative overlap prevent production classification until validation is complete.

Cross-SIEM decision

Splunk: no reliable SPL without a verified endpoint source, index, sourcetype and exact image and command-line fields.

Chronicle: no reliable YARA-L without a verified endpoint parser and exact UDM mapping for created process and command line.

Deferred ideas

Filename, domain and hash rules; WebClient correlation; ClickFix browser correlation; downstream Amatera, BYOVD, sideloading or NetSupport chains.

References

1. Cisco Talos, 8 Sep 2026 - ClearFake WebDAV infection chain delivers Amatera stealer, ZigCryptoStealer, and NetSupport Manager.
[blog\[.\]talosintelligence\[.\]com/clearfake-webdav-infection-chain/](https://blog.talosintelligence.com/clearfake-webdav-infection-chain/)
2. Microsoft Learn, updated 7 Aug 2026 - DeviceProcessEvents table.
[learn\[.\]microsoft\[.\]com/en-us/defender-xdr/advanced-hunting-deviceprocessevents-table](https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/defender-xdr/advanced-hunting-deviceprocessevents-table)
3. MITRE ATT&CK - T1218.011 Signed Binary Proxy Execution: Rundll32.
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